

Olmsted Falls survives scare by Demons



LINDA MURPHY/CHRONICLE

STANDING TALL: Tim Schaefer, Olmsted Falls' 6-8 center, scores over Westlake's Ryan Glau (45) and Jamie Justice (52).

SOUTHWESTERN ROUNDUP

Rocky River48
North Olmsted.....41

NORTH OLMSTED — After both teams traded dismal quarters in the first half, Rocky River came out firing in the second to steal a victory at North Olmsted in Southwestern Conference play.

The Eagles (3-5, 0-3 SWC) scored only one basket in the opening period, then allowed just three points in the second quarter to climb back into the game at the half, leading 19-17.

Foul shooting was a strength for both teams, as the Eagles sank all 12 attempts, while the Pirates (4-4, 3-2) made 15-18.

Kurt Cerny led North Olmsted with 18 points, including 10 in the second quarter. Rocky River was paced by Chad Standing's 19 points.

The Pirates visit Midpark today; the Eagles return to action next Tuesday at Fairview.

OR	G	F	T	NO	G	F	T
Outley	3	5	13	Talbot	2	4	8
Standing	3	7	19	Cerny	6	4	18
Moran	1	0	3	Selinger	3	0	7
Kennedy	2	0	4	Smith	1	2	4
Mizu	2	3	3	Back	1	2	4
Kruc	1	0	2				
Totals	13	15	48	Totals	13	12	41

Points by Quarters							
	1	2	3	4	T		
Rocky River	14	3	15	16	48		
North Olmsted	2	17	10	12	41		

Three-point goals: Rocky River 5 (Outley 2, Standing 2, Moran), North Olmsted 3 (Cerny 2, Selinger 1). Junior varsity: Rocky River, 29-31.

Amherst65
Fairview49

FAIRVIEW PARK — Todd Damasiewicz led all scorers with 19 points as Amherst topped Fairview.

Kris White added 12 points for the Comets (7-1, 4-1), who trail only unbeaten Olmsted Falls for the SWC lead.

Bobby Rosol scored 14 points to lead the Warriors (3-4, 1-3).

AMHERST (65): White 12, Damasiewicz 19, Outley 7, Dusha 8, Damasiewicz 15, Kelly 8, Lopez 2, Buskin 10.
FAIRVIEW (49): Skidmore 6, Busanus 7, Morris 4, Rosol 14, Phillips 11, Noor 3, Bell 4.
Points by Quarters
 Amherst 15 14 20 16 — 65
 Fairview 12 12 9 16 — 49
 Junior Varsity: Amherst, 33-44

Vermilion	G	F	T	Southview	G	F	T
E. Cyrek	4	15	23	Maswell	5	8	4
Purmler	5	2	14	Lane	5	1	12
Doane	4	4	12	Sanford	2	3	7
D. Cyrek	1	11	11	Pagan	2	0	3
Barnett	2	0	4	Oberonica	1	0	3
Barlett	1	0	2	Scirus	1	0	2
Acker	0	0	0	Shore	1	0	2
Shaw	0	0	0	rd	1	0	0
Cooper	0	0	2	Melendez	0	0	1
Dalshin	0	0	2	Francis	0	0	0
Zarobinski	0	0	0	Wingo	0	0	0
Struck	0	0	0				
Totals	22	23	67	Totals	21	11	58

Points by Quarters
 Vermilion 16 16 13 22 — 67
 Southview 12 15 11 24 — 58
 Three-point goals: Southview Pagan, Lane; Maswell, Sanford, Oberonica; JV: Southview, 61-40

Sailors held the lead throughout the game and finished the night shooting a fine 56 per cent from the field. The winners also capitalized on a 29-20 rebound advantage and got itself in position to cash in at the foul line. Senior Ed Cyrek was the main beneficiary, getting 15 of his game-high 23 points at the stripe.

Vermilion stretched it's biggest lead of the night to 55-40 midway through the fourth quarter, but Stark's crew would not allow the visitors to leave its gym without a fight. The Saints hung around and chipped the lead down to 58-50 with 1:45 to play, but could get no closer.

Southview got more shots from the field than its opponent (51 to 39) but was crippled from the foul stripe. Stark noted that this has been a season long pattern for his young team. "Our last game we outscored our opposition by ten field goals and still lost. This has been our biggest problem. Teams are shooting three times as many foul shots as us."

Steve Byrne
 The Chronicle-Telegram

WESTLAKE — Olmsted Falls is still undefeated, and the Bulldogs, no doubt, learned a lesson in their 61-57 victory over Westlake on Friday.

What that lesson was is hard to say. Maybe they learned they can stay undefeated, despite a little adversity, if they just keep cool. Perhaps they were shown just how delicate their winning streak is and that victories are not to be taken for granted. They could have been taught there's still plenty of work to do to keep the zero on the right side of the hyphen.

"This is a new experience for us," Falls coach Pat Donahue said. "Everyone is looking to knock us off. They're all going to put in a good week's practice to prepare for Olmsted Falls."

Whether Westlake put in a good week's practice will never

O.Falls	G	F	T	Westlake	G	F	T
Schaefer	8	2	18	Caponi	6	0	15
Matus	4	1	10	Westlake	1	0	2
Tabar	3	1	10	Blue	4	3	12
Moore	0	0	3	House	4	1	9
Neumst	2	2	6	Armstrong	3	2	10
Stony	2	2	7	Guiliano	0	0	0
Saprouba	1	5	7	Yanni	2	0	5
Moran	0	0	0	Glau	1	0	0
				Justice	0	0	0
				Elmer	1	0	2
Totals	26	16	81	Totals	22	6	57

Points by Quarters
 Olmsted Falls 15 20 7 19 — 61
 Westlake 16 18 13 — 57
 Three-point goals: Caponi 3, Tabar 3, Armstrong 2, Blue, Matus, Stony, Yanni
 Junior varsity: Westlake, 49-46

be known by anyone who wasn't there. The fact the Demons put in a good game is public knowledge.

"I'm proud," Westlake coach Art Daniels said. "They understood the game plan. They battled and scrapped all night. That's all a coach can ask for. They just have an empty feeling knowing how close they came."

The Demons, 5-4 overall and 3-2 in the Southwestern Conference, fought back from a nine-point deficit at halftime to tie the

score by the end of the third period and take a one-point lead twice in the fourth quarter. The second lead came when Gino Caponi sank a 3-point shot with 40 seconds to play to make it 57-56.

Tim Schaefer, who led all scorers with 18 and rebounders with 14, grabbed a missed 3-point attempt by Matt Tabar, scored and was fouled. Schaefer canned the free throw to give the Bulldogs a two-point edge with 25 seconds to play.

Westlake's last gasp, a running one-hand shot on the baseline by Kyle Blue, missed the mark. Jerome Moore grabbed the rebound and was fouled with three seconds left. Moore hit both shots and Falls (8-0, 4-0 SWC) had its victory.

"We have three step-up guys — Schaefer, Matus and Tabar," Donahue said. "People might wonder why Tabar took a 3-pointer in that situation (last

half-minute, Falls trailing by a point), but that's what he does. The kids on this team know their roles. Wes just need to get a little more consistent."

The Bulldogs were inconsistent in the third quarter. Nine turnovers and 2-of-8 field goal shooting allowed the Demons to get back in the game. Westlake had a 13-3 scoring advantage in the final 4:33 of the third frame.

A 10-0 run in the second quarter and a 17-2 burst between the first and second frames lifted Falls into its lead. The Bulldogs couldn't shake Westlake as the Demons held an 8-6 scoring edge in the final 2½ minutes of the first half.

"They (Westlake) have a very underrated team," Donahue said. "They remind me of us last year. Their kids play well together and people tend to overlook them."

The Dogs used their superior height to fashion a 38-19 edge in rebounding.

Bay rallies to squeak by Avon Lake

Chris Assenheimer
 The Chronicle-Telegram

BAY VILLAGE — What was once a key battle between traditional Southwestern Conference titans, Friday night's 57-55 victory by Bay over visiting Avon Lake meant little in the current tie picture.

The Rockets — SWC champs six out of seven seasons from 1982 to 1989 — and the Shoremen — the most successful team in the conference the last decade with five league titles — are now both under .500.

Still, it was a win for Bay, and head coach Dick Scott isn't discriminating against any of the W's this year.

"It was a very good win," said Scott whose Rockets climbed to 2-5 overall and 2-3 in the conference after losing four straight to begin the season. "We'll take any one we can get. Credit our defense for that one. We changed it up and kept them off balance."

For Avon Lake it was a game that got away.

Bay	G	F	T	A.Lake	G	F	T
Miller	7	4	20	Strauch	1	0	3
Murphy	0	0	0	Petrys	2	2	7
Musulin	2	1	0	Fall	1	1	3
Kotarsky	1	0	2	Nelson	1	1	3
Zastudil	1	3	5	Port	3	0	7
Zeb	1	1	1	McLara	3	2	9
Worland	0	0	0	McLara	0	0	0
Alexander	3	0	6	Jicha	4	7	15
Surge	0	0	0	Schaefer	3	2	8
Glenn	6	4	16				
Totals	21	13	57	Totals	18	15	55

Points by Quarters
 Bay Village 19 15 12 20 — 57
 Avon Lake 11 19 10 15 — 55
 Three-point goals: Bay, Miller 2; Avon Lake, Strauch, Port, Matt Lara, Petrys; Junior varsity: Avon Lake 53-51

The Shoremen led after each of the first three quarters and held a 53-48 advantage with under four minutes left to play.

"It was a game we could have won," said A.L. head coach Dick Deasy, whose team dipped to 3-5 overall and remained winless in the conference at 0-3. "We didn't help ourselves down the stretch and gave them a couple easy baskets. I'm not disappointed though. We played hard."

The first half was a foul-fest, featuring 34 free throw attempts

and 29 fouls between the two teams.

Senior guards Matt Pertys and Brian Jicha led a Shoremen charge that saw A.L. take a double-digit lead (27-16) in the second quarter before the Rockets closed on a 9-3 run to get within five. The pair combined for 16 of their team's 30 points for the half.

Jicha was the only Shoremen in double figures, finishing with 15 points on the night.

"Jicha played an excellent game tonight," Deasy said. "He was very smart in the middle for us."

But Jicha's output was not enough to stop Bay's duo of long range bomber Bobby Miller and guard Ray Glenn in the fourth quarter.

The seniors scored 18 of Bay's 20 final period points, leading a comeback run that ended in the Rockets grabbing their first lead of the opening minutes of the game.

Miller finished with a game-high 20, while Glenn scored 12 second half points to log 16 on the night.

It was Glenn's pair from the line that knotted the score at 53 with 2:50 remaining, and it was Miller's three-pointer from the baseline that gave Bay the lead for good at 56-55 with 1:50 left on the clock

"Glenn came off the bench and played really well for us," Scott said. "It was actually, who threw the pass to Bobby for the three-pointer. Bobby grew up in Avon Lake (before moving after his eighth grade year) so it was nice for him to hit a bucket like that."

It was Glenn who killed the Shoremen chances at a last second win, when with Bay in front by the final count he plucked the ball from sophomore Nate Port as he maneuvered his way across the top of the key for the would be game winning shot.

The Rockets take their act on the road Tuesday night in Brecksville, while Avon Lake returns home to face SWC rival Westlake.

Vermilion drops Southview to 0-8

John Ciarrone
 The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN-Larry Stark has seen his share of challenges in 21 years as head basketball coach of Southview.

And his challenge for 1996 seems to be how to take his band of young, energetic basketball players and mold them into a mature and cohesive unit.

"I've said it all along it's going to take awhile with our kids," said Stark. "Before it's over we're going to be very, very, competitive. I think our younger kids may be coming of age."

Despite dropping Friday night's Erie Shore Conference game with Vermilion 67-58, which put the Saints winless at 0-8, Stark found reason for optimism.

"You can look at our record, but you also have to look at who we've played. My concern is that the terrific schedule we've played so far got the kids down a little. But now they're finding they can play with teams."

Although Southview started four seniors, its' bench contained all underclassmen and there were plenty of youthful mistakes to go around-on either side. Vermilion and Southview committed nine turnovers each in the opening quarter. Vermilion's bench boss Bob Walsh was not pleased as he assessed his team's effort.

"We didn't play well. We had too many unforced turnovers" claimed Walsh, his team now at 6-3 overall and 2-1 in the ESC. Despite Walsh's reservations, the

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